

Masks" and "Yiwarra Kuju: The Canning Stock Route"– set the main biennale program's intellectual and curatorial tone.

Evenings at the Biennale shimmered with movement and music. On 7 August, Indonesian and Thai troupes performed under the open sky, their dances echoing the cultural exchanges narrated in the galleries. The next evening, the Indonesian Cultural Troupe returned with performances rich in gesture and costume, and on 9 August, the stage belonged to the young students of Kilkari Bal Bhawan, whose energy closed the opening week on a note of exuberant local participation.

Bihar Museum: Redefining Museum Practice .

Over the years, the Bihar Museum, Patna is turning static repositories into dynamic, experiential cultural hubs. In its architecture and collections, it holds fragments of time–stone, script, textile, image. Yet in this moment, the museum becomes more than a space of preservation. It becomes a site of becoming. A space where contemporary practices meet ancestral rhythms, and where art becomes a means of rewriting, not just recalling, the past. The museum has taken a pioneering initiative in the form of Bihar Museum Biennale to redefine the role of museums in a globalised world. It aims to promote cultural exchange by bringing together museums, institutions and creative professionals to share ideas, exhibitions and experiences. Representing a paradigmatic shift in contemporary museological practice, the BMB addresses a critical gap in the cultural sector by providing museums in India and the international community with a



forum for scholarly exchanges, cultural dialogue and collaborative exhibition practices.

The Biennale's theoretical framework extends beyond traditional exhibition models, offering a platform for conversations and connections across heritage, culture, art, history, living traditions and museum management. Emerging as the world's first museum-focused biennale, it has fundamentally transformed the landscape of cultural institutions globally. This pioneering initiative emerged from the recognition that while numerous art, design and architecture biennales exist worldwide, no dedicated platform exists for





museums to showcase their collections, methodologies and institutional narratives.

The inaugural BMB in 2021, conducted virtually due to pandemic constraints, established the foundational theme of **"Bihar, India and the World: Connecting People, Connecting Cultures... In Changing Times."**

This edition successfully engaged prestigious Indian institutions, including the **Assam State Museum, City Palace Museum Udaipur, Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj Vastu Sangrahalaya (CSMVS) Mumbai, Indira Gandhi Rashtriya Manav Sangrahalaya Bhopal, Kiran Nadar Museum of Art (KNMA) in New Delhi, and the National Gallery of Modern Art New Delhi,** among others. In 2023, the second edition was an on-site Biennale, and more than fifteen countries participated, including Indian museums like Salarjung in Hyderabad, KNMA in Mumbai, and CSMVS in Mumbai. The G20 Art Exhibition 'Together We Art' was also included in the Bihar Biennale's second edition

Now the **third edition** of the Biennale has expanded its focus to connect museums and collections from Global South across Africa, South America and Asia. Connecting various cultures and countries across the Indian Ocean and maritime trade routes presents a unique opportunity to blend aesthetics, mythologies, indigenous and contemporary arts, crafts, belief systems and performing arts of these countries. This biennale provides a dynamic platform to celebrate artistic and historical connections that the Global South collectively shares. The third edition is a stage for conversations around heritage, culture, art, history, management and creating new narratives for the museums of today's world.